

xMCF

ISO/PAS 8329

Description of mechanical connections
and joints in structural systems

ISO/PAS 8329 xMCF WG meeting
2026-01-14

Meeting results are
added in green font.

energizing great minds

Draft Agenda

As announced at https://github.com/economidis-nick/createXSDforxMCF/tree/master/VDA_FAT_AK_25/Meetings/2026-01-14_VideoConference

- Welcome
- New members (Marc Schöffler, PM for new joining tool @Ford / Arnav, intern @Bosch)
- Software news
- xMCF-related findings in PTC Creo (postponed)
- Recent progress & next steps regarding issues [#105](#) and [#61](#).
 - Summary & program for the next xMCF release
 - New structures in GitHub / Initial implementation of the decisions from the last meeting
 - Presentation and discussion of example files provided as comments to [#105](#)
- Timeline for a release in the summer
- Steps we should take next



Updates on Software Support Status

CAE Tool	Status	Comment
Beta CAE ANSA	G	Most types r/w
Altair Hypermesh	Y	Many types r/w
Siemens Simcenter3D	Y	Many types r/w
Magna FEMFAT	Y	Basic types r/w
Siemens Virtual.Lab	Y	Basic types r/w
HBK nCode	Y	Basic types r
Dassault MODSIM	R	Investigating
OASYS	Y	χMCF import announced
GNS/Generator 4	R	On product roadmap
CAD Tool	Status	Comment
Dassault CATIA V6	R	Committed for CATIA
Siemens NX	R	On NX product roadmap
PTC Creo	R	On Creo product roadmap

Andrew White, 2025-10-12:
“the pre-processing component
of the [Oasys LS-DYNA Environment](#) software,
Oasys PRIMER,
will support reading χMCF files
from our next release version 23.0.”
(Scheduled for spring 2026.)

⇒ Status updated from “R” to “Y”.

GitHub Issues — Top 6

<https://dud-poll.inf.tu-dresden.de/xMCF/> — as of 2025-11-12, 11:00 CET

Top 	Med 	#	Title	Volunteers
6	0	105	Support connection 0/1/2d to be reused (e.g. multiple occurrences)	CF, UF, NE, SH
4	2	61	xMCF shall Support Catalogs, e.g. of Standard Parts / Joining Elements	CF, UF, NE, JB
4	2	92	Setup a Document with Recommendations / Best Practices of xMCF Usage	CF, IR
4	2	95	Add persistent identifier to connection group	CF, UF, GH, NE, SH, TR
3	2	94	Add instance identifier to a connector	CF, UF, GH, NE, SH, TR
3	1	59	Mapping between xMCF and other established systems	CF, TR

Comments & Hints:

- Public example CAD files are attached to [#104](#), which could be useful for [#92](#).

Short recap. Where are we today?

- In the last meeting, we made decisions regarding the organization of the work in GitHub. These decisions have been implemented immediately afterwards. (See next slides.)
- We decided to focus on the issues [#105](#) and [#61](#), first, but want to include the issues [#94](#) and [#95](#) in the next release, too.
- We decided to strive for summer 2026 for this release. This would require χ MCF 3.2 to be submitted to ISO by April/May 2026.
- For today, we welcome suggestions / examples about modifications / extensions to the χ MCF format which address issues [#105](#) and [#61](#).



Organizational Action Items: GitHub Structure and Version Code

- **Branching:**

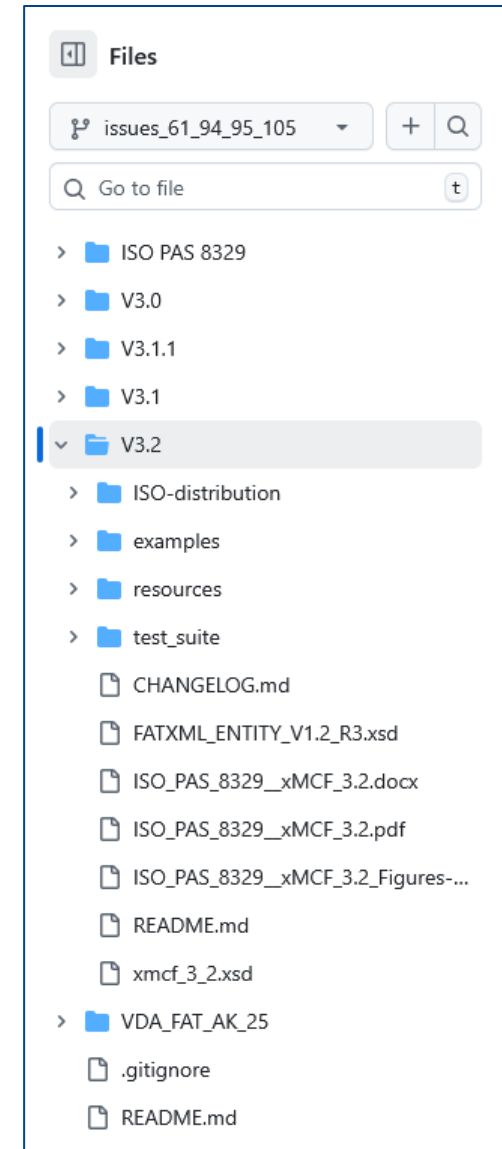
To separate the changes from the last released version (branch [master](#)), the new branch [issues 61 94 95 105](#) has been created.

- **Directory structure:**

There, the new directory *V3.2* incl. sub-directories for *ISO-distribution*, *examples*, *resources* and *test_suite* have been arranged.

- **Versioning:**

In the new branch, the xMCF version code was increased from 3.1.1 to **3.2**. Documents with 3.2 in their file names have been created as *copies* of the old files. The copied documents do not yet contain any changes to the content.



Organizational Action Items: Milestone in GitHub

- **Milestone:**
The existing milestone “Release after V3.1.1” has been renamed to “[Release V3.2](#)”.

The corresponding issues have been collected, there.

The screenshot shows a GitHub Milestone page for 'Release V3.2'. At the top, there are buttons for 'Edit', 'Close Milestone', and 'New issue'. Below the title, it indicates the milestone is 'Open', due by May 7, 2026, last updated last month, and 0% complete. A description states: 'At the core team meeting on 10 December 2025, it was decided that we would aim for a release 3.2 in summer 2026. This release is intended to cover issues #61, #94, #95, and #105.' Below this, there are filters for 'Open' (4) and 'Closed' (0). The list of issues includes: 1. 'χMCF shall Support Catalogs, e.g. of Standard Parts / Joining Elements' (AK, enhancement, #61, opened Feb 5, 2021, 3 comments). 2. 'Add instance identifier to a connector' (AK, enhancement, #94, opened Jan 30, 2024). 3. 'Add persistent identifier to connection_group' (AK, enhancement, #95, opened Jan 30, 2024). 4. 'Support connection_0/1/2d to be reused (for example on multiple occurrences within one connection_group or over multiple connection_groups)' (AK, enhancement, #105, opened Mar 20, 2025, 6 comments).

Recent Contributions

- A discussion about potential solutions was started yesterday under issue [#105](#), see <https://github.com/economidis-nick/createXSDforxMCF/issues/105#issuecomment-3744198077>.

Suggestion (CF): Let's continue this discussion in a “focus group” as soon as possible.

- Copies of [ISO 13584-511:2006](#) and [ISO 1891:2009](#) have been provided for internal use to facilitate work on issue 61.

A sincere *thank you* to all donors!



Discussion about potential solutions under issue #105

- Examples provided as comments by [GH](#) & [CF](#) have been discussed.
- Specific advantages and disadvantages were debated.
- The working group concluded that we have found a good starting point. However, further work on the details is required.
- We plan to meet again next week to discuss this, possibly in a smaller, technically oriented “focus group”.



Contentual Action Items $\triangleq$ Next Steps:

- **Standard document (Word file):**

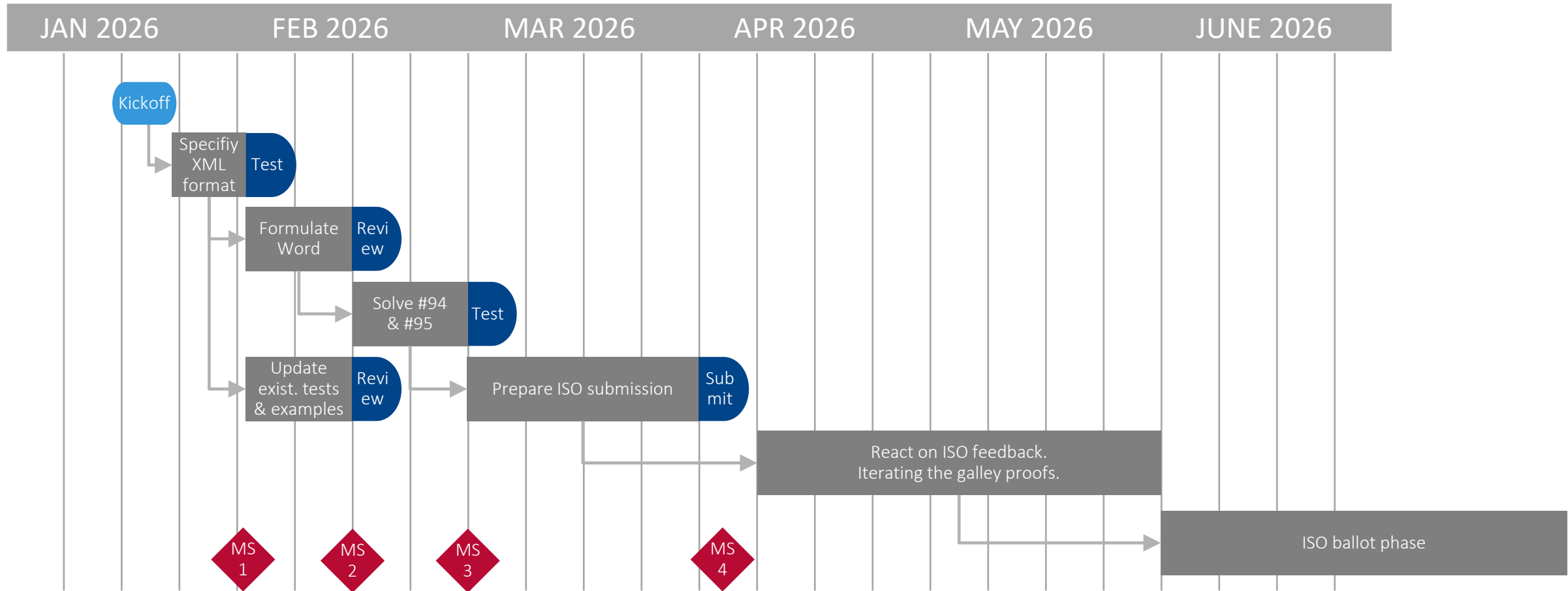
- Description of overall concept & objectives, intended application & motivation etc.
- Description of semantics for internal catalog
- Description of semantics for reference to a catalog item
- Definition of example use cases and in-document XML-examples

- **XML & XSD** — See discussion in [#105!](#)

- Sketching XML example file(s), incl. (w.i.p.)
 - precedence rule and dropped mandatory attribute,
 - internal and external file-based catalog
- Description of syntax for catalogs
- Description of syntax for reference to a catalog item:
 - internal (w.i.p.), external file-based, external database-based
- Drafting XML schema (XSD) (w.i.p.) and test cases / test example files



Timeline for a release in the summer



Updating the PAS shall be cross-checked with the chair of ISO TC 184 / SC 4. Or shall we strive for an IS instead of a PAS, directly?

Attention: Change to IS requires file conversion from Word to OSD-System.

⇒ Max & Jean will take these questions to the PPC meeting, next week.

Next meetings

- 2026-01-21, 15:00 CET — focus group on [#105](#) / [#61](#) (CF, NE, GH, SH, JB, ...)
 - objective: create XML format suggestions
- 2026-01-28, 15:00 CET — full group
 - objective: agree on XML format suggestions
- 2026-02-??, ??:?? CET — focus group on [#105](#) / [#61](#) (CF, NE, GH, SH, JB, ...)
 - objective: create DOC suggestions & examples
- 2026-02-11, 15:00 CET — full group
 - objective: agree on DOC suggestions & examples

CF will send out invitations.

